

resulted in a noticeable decline in service quality, marked by poorly maintained cabs, frequent cancellations, and extended wait times.

For Jaggi, the gaps in the ride-hailing sector became apparent. The duo invested two years, immersing themselves in the ride-hailing world, jet-setting across the US and beyond to meet with charging companies and EV manufacturers. The result? An all-electric ride-hailing service that hit the streets in mid-2019.

“We realised the challenges in the ride-hailing industry were one too many. On the user side, we found that high number of ride cancellations, unhygienic cars and unpredictable fares were major pain points. On the driver partner side, we found that the drivers were unhappy with the burden to own and maintain the assets, and it was affecting their stable livelihood,” says 38-year-old Jaggi.

Soon Tushar Garg, Rishabh Sood, and Anirudh Arun joined their mission as co-founders.

The inaugural fleet of EV cars initially operated on the Uber platform, paving the way for the start-up to eventually craft its own app. Emerging as an independent entity, the company introduced fixed prices and scheduled rides, addressing user apprehensions related to surge pricing and cancellations.

As the next step, they had to solve for the obvious charging challenge. The biggest hurdle to widespread EV adoption lay in the charging infrastructure, and it proved to be both a bottleneck and a significant opportunity. The company soon launched Charging Superhubs, now strategically positioned in prime locations, spanning 1.3 million sq. ft, serving the entire electric mobility ecosys-

tem. The company currently owns and operates over 4,000 charging stations.

Thus, BluSmart is shaping an integrated energy-infrastructure-mobility and technology business, aimed at achieving widespread decarbonisation of mobility. Today, the company runs India's largest EV ride-hailing service, with more than 5,500 cars zipping across the bustling mobility markets of Delhi NCR and Bengaluru.

BluSmart thrives on enhanced profitability, thanks to its larger-ticket trips and cost-efficient fleet. Leasing EVs at an institutional level ensures a price advantage

successfully executing 10 million electric trips, covering over 330 million electric km, saving nearly 24,000 metric tonnes of CO₂. The company also claims that it has crossed \$50 million in annual revenue run-rate and is growing at more than 100 per cent year-on-year.

“As a start-up with the ambition to disrupt public transportation, we knew that we had to do it in a way that not only actively improves the mobility ecosystem but also takes emissions into consideration. Our vision has been to decarbonise mobility at scale,” says Jaggi.

Larger-ticket trips and a cost-efficient EV fleet boost BluSmart's profitability

coupled with lower fuel costs for minimal cash burn. Operating on par with competitors' charges, BluSmart maintains a cost structure 30-40 per cent lower, steering towards its profitability goal. This allows the company to deliver on-time, professional, and clean cabs—all at prices comparable to its competitors.

For drivers, the company alleviates a significant financial burden by eliminating the necessity to own cabs. It also provides them insurance coverage and essential amenities such as resting places and dining facilities. Since its inception, BluSmart has onboarded more than 18,000 driver partners.

The company credits its indigenously built technology stack for

Moving ahead, the company's expansion strategy involves scaling across Delhi NCR and Bengaluru in the near term.

“We aim to expand our EV fleet to 8000 cars by next year, and further strengthen our charging infrastructure to accommodate the growing demand. Additionally, creating more earning opportunities for our driver partners, particularly increasing the representation of female drivers, is a key short-term goal,” he adds.

In its forward-looking vision, BluSmart isn't merely providing rides; it's a journey towards a greener tomorrow. **BT**

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